```
When Bill views his account summary
Then Bill should see all of his accounts
```

❸ No need to repeat the table.

❷ Assume that he needs to log in first.

The preconditions here are that Bill is registered for online banking and that he has two accounts ❶. If authentication has been specified elsewhere, you can probably safely assume that Bill needs to log in to see his accounts. The preconditions are also phrased in the past tense to make it more obvious that these actions are assumed to have already occurred. How Bill gets to the accounts summary page is also not the main focus of this test, so this is hidden inside step ❷. The action under test is now a one-liner that more accurately represents the business action you're specifying.

The `Then` clause has also been simplified here ❸ by assuming that you can reuse the accounts list provided in the preconditions. This reduces clutter and focuses on the essence of the expected outcome.

5.4.2 Writing expressive When steps

The aim of the `When` step is to execute the event or action you're testing. Like the `Given` step, the `When` step should describe the action in terms of *what*, not *how*.

The following scenario, for example, is too long and far too focused on the detailed steps involved in interacting with the user interface. This makes it tightly coupled to the implementation, which in turn makes it fragile and costly to maintain. The length of the scenario also makes it harder to read, which reduces its use as a communication medium:

```
Scenario: Register for online banking
Given that Bill wants to register for online banking
When he goes to the registration page
And he enters 'Bill' in the first name field
And he enters 'Smith' in the surname field
And he enters 'bill@smith.com" in the email field
And he enters '01/01/1980' in the date of birth field
And he enters '1 George street' in the street field
And he enters 'Sydney' in the city field
And he enters '2000' in the post code field
And he clicks on submit
Then his application should be created in a pending state
And he should be sent a PDF contract to sign by email
```

❶ A detailed account of the application process

The expected outcomes

This is very dense, and it contains a lot of detail about what values should go in each field on the registration page ❶. But do you really need this much detail? Although it's using the user interface, this scenario is actually testing the online registration process, not the user interface. So you could hide these details in a single higher-level step, as shown here:

```
Scenario: Register for online banking
Given that Bill wants to register for online banking with the following
     details:
first-name|surname|email          |dob       |street|city   | postcode
Bill      |Smith  |bill@smith.com|01/01/1980| ...  |Sydney| 2000
```

❶ Field values are now stored in a table.